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A push to impeach, with eye on ballot box

Democratic lawmakers target Cabinet heads as they confront own challenging elections

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The killing of Renee Good by Immigrations and Customs Enforcement agents in Minneapolis may have been why Representative Robin Kelly, an Illinois Democrat, decided to launch impeachment proceedings against Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem.

And while Kelly's outrage over Noem's actions may be as genuine as any other Democrat's — more than 180 colleagues

have since signed on to her resolution — there's no question the impeachment push is giving her an edge as she campaigns for a US Senate seat.

It's not that the embattled Noem will come anywhere near being impeached by a Republican-led Congress, even though there is a mounting backlash within both parties to her department's deadly immigration crackdown, especially after agents killed a second protester in Minnesota in late January.

Instead, Kelly has tapped into the is-



Secretary Kristi Noem has been targeted by Representative Robin Kelly.

sue most animating her party's voters right now with the kind of aggressive pushback they are increasingly craving from their elected leaders.

Far from being an outlier, Kelly is representative of a trend among House Democrats that could see impeachment, long the legislative branch's most weighty check on other branches, used even more as a short-term electoral strategy.

As the 2026 midterms approach, nearly every one of the lawmakers pushing impeachment articles of President Trump and Cabinet officials is either competing in a primary for higher office or seeking to fend off a primary challenge at home.

IMPEACHMENT, Page A4

BPS warns of layoffs as budget gap grows

Many of cuts expected at schools slated to close

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Parents, students, and educators in Boston Public Schools are bracing for bad news this week, when Superintendent Mary Skipper plans to offer her budget plan for the coming fiscal year: For the second time in three years, BPS is looking at job cuts.

At least 300 to 400 positions could be cut across the district, including teachers, paraprofessionals, and support staff, according to BPS's chief financial officer, David Bloom.

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A "significant portion" of the reduction will include positions at three schools planned to close at the end of the school year, Bloom told the School Committee in December. The district has not yet

said specifically where the cuts would occur.

The expected reductions follow warnings from administrators in December of rising health insurance costs, transportation expenses, and special education costs, as well as increased costs associated with labor contracts.

The budget for the upcoming fiscal year will be officially presented to the School Committee on Wednesday.

BPS also cut jobs ahead of the 2024-2025 school year budget, when 70 percent of schools saw some reductions in staffing, totaling about 393 full-time equivalent positions.

The latest round of possible job cuts, representing about 4 percent of the district's total staff, comes after several years of spending increases that were intended to support students recovering from the pandemic and expand services for special education and English language learners.

SCHOOLS, Page A7



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

The family of a crewman aboard the Lily Jean left a candle near the altar at the start of a memorial service in Gloucester.

‘Help us understand this loss’

Mourners gather in Gloucester to remember victims of Lily Jean vessel

By Sarah Rahal
and Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

GLOUCESTER — Every pew and standing space at Saint Ann Church in this coastal city was filled Sunday with parishioners and members of the tight-knit fishing community. They came, church leaders said, to honor “the families and all of those who have died

at sea,” after the Lily Jean, a 72-foot fishing vessel with seven people on board, sank offshore early Friday morning.

“In the Lord of sea and sky . . . help us understand this loss,” said the Rev. James Achadinha, his words echoing through the crowded sanctuary.

In a city long shaped by the sea, about 1,000 people gathered to mourn the seven

people presumed dead. Two victims have been identified: Sean Therrien, 44, a Lynn native who had recently taken a winter job on the Lily Jean after being laid off from construction work, and Jada Samitt, a 22-year-old federal fisheries observer from Virginia. The Coast Guard and church leaders did not confirm the names of the other victims.

GLOUCESTER, Page A7

Here at Somerville pit, questions rise along with murky, slushy water

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — Some called it the “Forbidden Swimming Hole.”

Others said the vacant pit at 15 McGrath Highway, with a footprint the size of two-and-a-half Olympic swimming pools, would be perfect for “boat coliseum battles.”

Or, in homage to the local business that once stood at the site: “The Sav-Mor Liquors Memorial Swimming Pool.”

Whatever you call it, the site of a paused lab space construction project in a busy section of Somerville and its many, many gallons of un-swimmable water has been

turning heads here for more than a year. Now, for the first time, the owner of the land says it's all part of the plan.

Stay with us as we dive into the history.

For years, the site was home to a low-slung strip mall and Sav-Mor Liquors. When that location closed for good in 2022, Sav-Mor announced the change in its well-known witty style on its sign outside: “Thank you for 40 great years. Moved to Assembly Row. Don't tell Todd.”

The plan under owner Leggat McCall Properties was for a nine-

PIT, Page A6

ONE MORE GOAL TO GO



MARK STOCKWELL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Patriots quarterback Drake Maye addressed thousands of fans who braved bitter temperatures at a Gillette Stadium rally Sunday before the team headed to California. **B1.**

Federal courts, ruling against a Trump administration policy intended to keep immigrants detained indefinitely, have released hundreds of detainees. **A2.**

In a hopeful sign for Palestinians in Gaza Strip, preparations were underway to open up their lifeline to the world: the Rafah border crossing with Egypt. **A3.**

A lack of new information from federal authorities on the Brown University shooting has prompted members of Congress and local police to demand answers. **B1.**

President Trump said he will move to close the Kennedy Center performing arts venue in Washington for two years starting in July for construction. **A10.**



All set to glow

Monday: Calmer, some sun. High 30-35, low 8-13.

Tuesday: Higher temps. High 33-38, low 17-22.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

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Sweet sound of victory

Kendrick Lamar (right) won a second consecutive record of the year trophy at the Grammy Awards in Los Angeles Sunday night, with SZA for their duet “Luther.” **B6.**



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